e

Assessment

the Course

Understanding Critical Concepts in marketing

Session 1

Grounding -

- What is marketing
- The Course

Session 2

Critical Concepts

- Needs, wants, Demands
- Consumer vs Customer
- Marketing Environment



Knowing Consumers Better

Session 3

Consumer Behavior

- Neuroscience
- Consumer Buying Behavior – Consumer Bias
- Consumer Funnels

Session 4

Target Consumer

- Segmenting & Targeting
- Pen Profiles
- Understanding Motivations

Session 5

Customer value

- Types of Benefits
- Differentiation
- Positioning



We need to define ***User TG*** and **Anchor TG?**



Defining the Target Consumer: User TG vs. Communication TG

User TG

- The universe of consumers who may consider your brand

Communication TG

- A sharply defined consumer group which holds the most potential for the brand



Relation between User and Communication TG

- The User TG will either
  - reflect,
  - resonate with or
  - aspire to be like

the Communication TG



Nike









Anchor TG

Athletes and performance obsessed 25. year-old – Fitness driven, edgy, aspirational

User TG

Gym goers, casual walkers, Kids, sneaker heads, Fashion conscious, etc.

Thar









Anchor TG

Young Male Explorers, Urban Adventurers- Strong sense of freedom, self expression

User TG

Working professional, families from Tier 2 , Men in their 40s buying into a youth fantasy

TG of *Epigamia*

Communication TG – M/F, 28, Metro, NCCSA Bold, Ambitious, Lifestyle & Convenience Seeker

User TG – **5cr. Consumers**, 18-60 in the top **50 towns**



Defining Anchor TG

Different Consumers!

DEMOGRAPHICS–

Old/young/Mid aged

Metro/ Middle-India/Rural

South/North India

Graduate/10th Pass/Uneducated --
Super Rich/ Middle Class/Poor

Married/Unmarried --
Male/Female/Transgender



PSYCHOGRAPHICS–

Liberal/Conservative

Explorer vs Control

Quality Conscious vs Price Conscious

Individual vs Collective

Restless vs Pragmatic

One size does not fit all!

- ✔ Non homogeneity of the Consumer
- ✔ Multilayered and Complex decision process
- ✔ Seeking different benefit and attaching value to those benefits

Need to *Segment the Market*

What is a segment?

A distinct group (sub- group) of consumers, who share a similar set of wants

Marketing task

Identify these segments

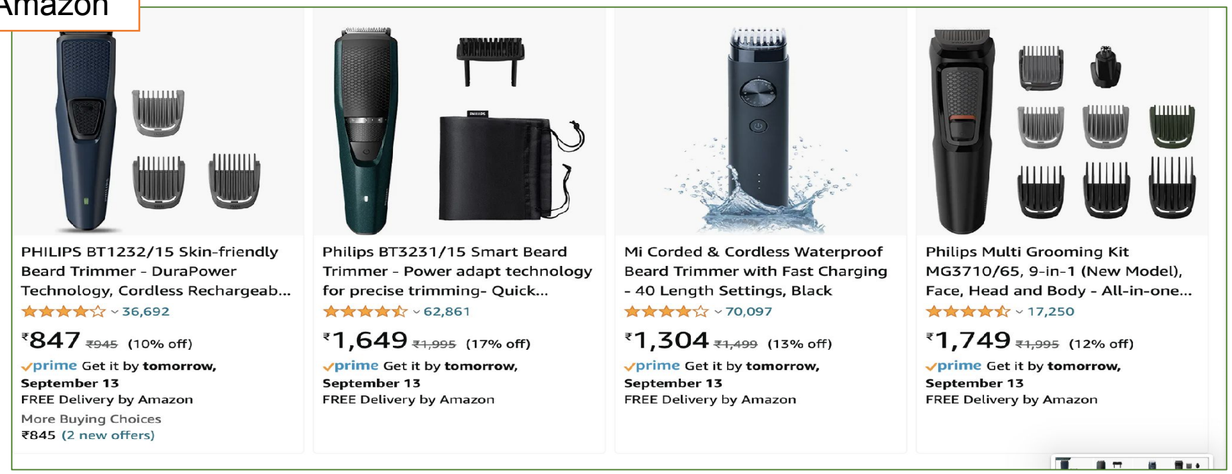
- ✔ … decide which to target (Targeting)
- ✔ Two broad variables at play in segmenting
  - Descriptive characteristics
  - Behavioral characteristics
- ✔ Tailor marketing programs basis the segmentations

Descriptive Variables

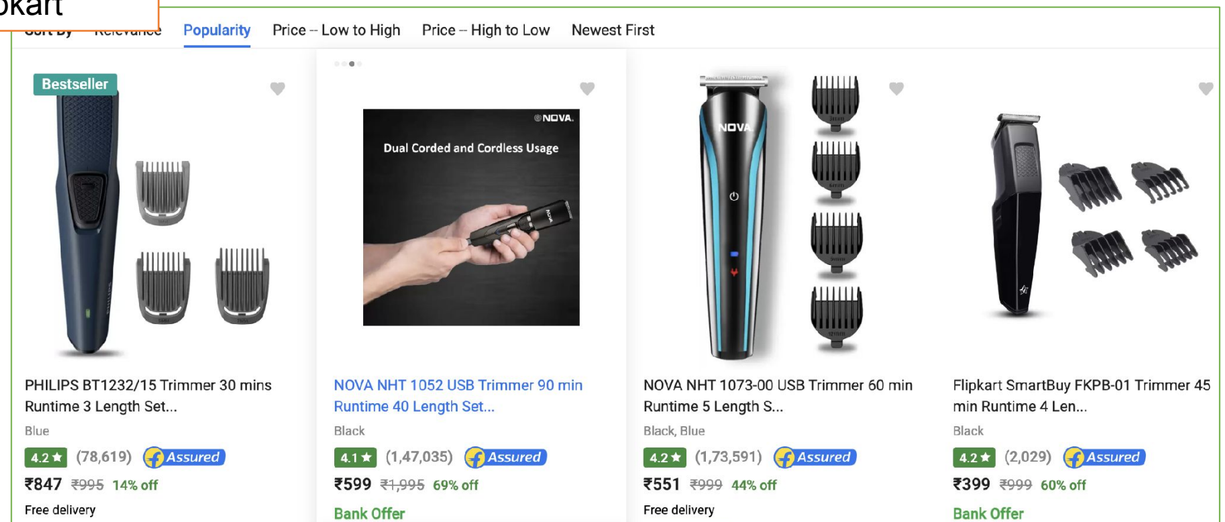
Demographic - Geography

- ✔ Nation/States/Cities/neighborhoods/pin codes
- ✔ Town classification/Density – e.g. All villages above 5k population, Urban/Rural.

Amazon



Flipkart



Trimmers is one of the fastest growing categories in India

Category that span across all Urban (not just metro-centric

Amazon and flipkart's platform segmentation is very clear when you search trimmers!

The top searches on Amazon are premium high-priced trimmers, whereas that off FK is low priced, local trimmers

Amazon is a platform that focuses on metro/tier 1 segment, FK is Tier 2/3

Philips also focuses it plans based on the segment focus of each platform

Descriptive Variables

Demographic - Other

- ✔ Age – 1-6, 6-14, 14-25, 25-38….
- ✔ Life stage – Teen, DINKs, First jobbers,

Byju's has offerings tailormade to age/Life stage segments

(1-3 I 4-10, Online Tutoring I JEE/NEET, CAT, IAS)





Descriptive Variables

Demographic - Other

- ✔ Gender- Male/Female
- ✔ Ethnicity – North/South, Afro –American, etc

CPG focus has moved to segmenting by gender

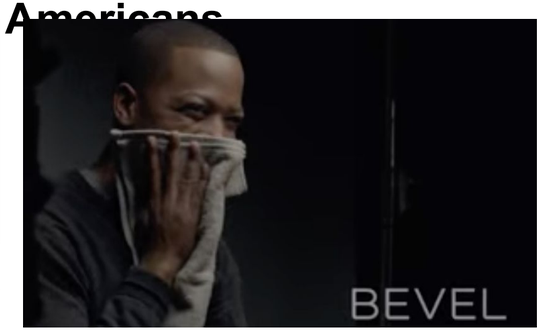






Many products in the US are targeting Ethnicity- e.g – Bevel , Drive legacy & Culture of Afro - Americans







Descriptive Variables

Demographic - Income

- ✔ Based on Disposable income/spends
- ✔ Socio Economic Classification- NCCS A/B/C

Cadbury has used Income level Segmentation to diversify its portfolio into Premium offering like Silk and low unit packs like Shots to counter the toffee penetration in Rural





New age starts up are trying to capture the NCCS A/B consumer – Classification based on education and ownership

EDUCATION OF CWE

No. of Durables Owned	Illiterate	Literate but no formal school/ School upto 4 yrs	School- 5 to 9 years	SSC/ HSC	Some College (incl Diploma) but not Grad	Grad/ PG: General	Grad/ PG: Professional
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
None	E3	E2	E2	E2	E2	E1	D2
1	E2	E1	E1	E1	D2	D2	D2
2	E1	E1	D2	D2	D1	D1	D1
3	D2	D2	D1	D1	C2	C2	C2
4	D1	C2	C2	C1	C1	B2	B2
5	C2	C1	C1	B2	B1	B1	B1
6	C1	B2	B2	B1	A3	A3	A3
7	C1	B1	B1	A3	A3	A2	A2
8	B1	A3	A3	A3	A2	A2	A2
200 × 718	B1	A3	A3	A2	A2	A1	A1

Behavioral Variables

User/Usage Related Parameters

- ✔ User Status – Current Users vs Lapsers
- ✔ Usage Rate – Light, Medium and Heavy Users
- ✔ Readiness/Funnel – Aware, Interested, Tried, Returned, Loyal

Usage Funnels tracked regularly and useful way to segment consumers of category



Axe Used Psychographics To Segment and Target Consumers

Axe positioning is built on understanding the consumer segment and picking one and arriving at pain points on which concept is built

Predator – Who took advantages of his girls

Natural Talent – Athletic, smart and confident

Marriage Material – Humble, respectful, want to introduce his to parents

Always friend – Always hits that glass ceiling

Insecure novice – No clue what he is doing!, awkward, needs help

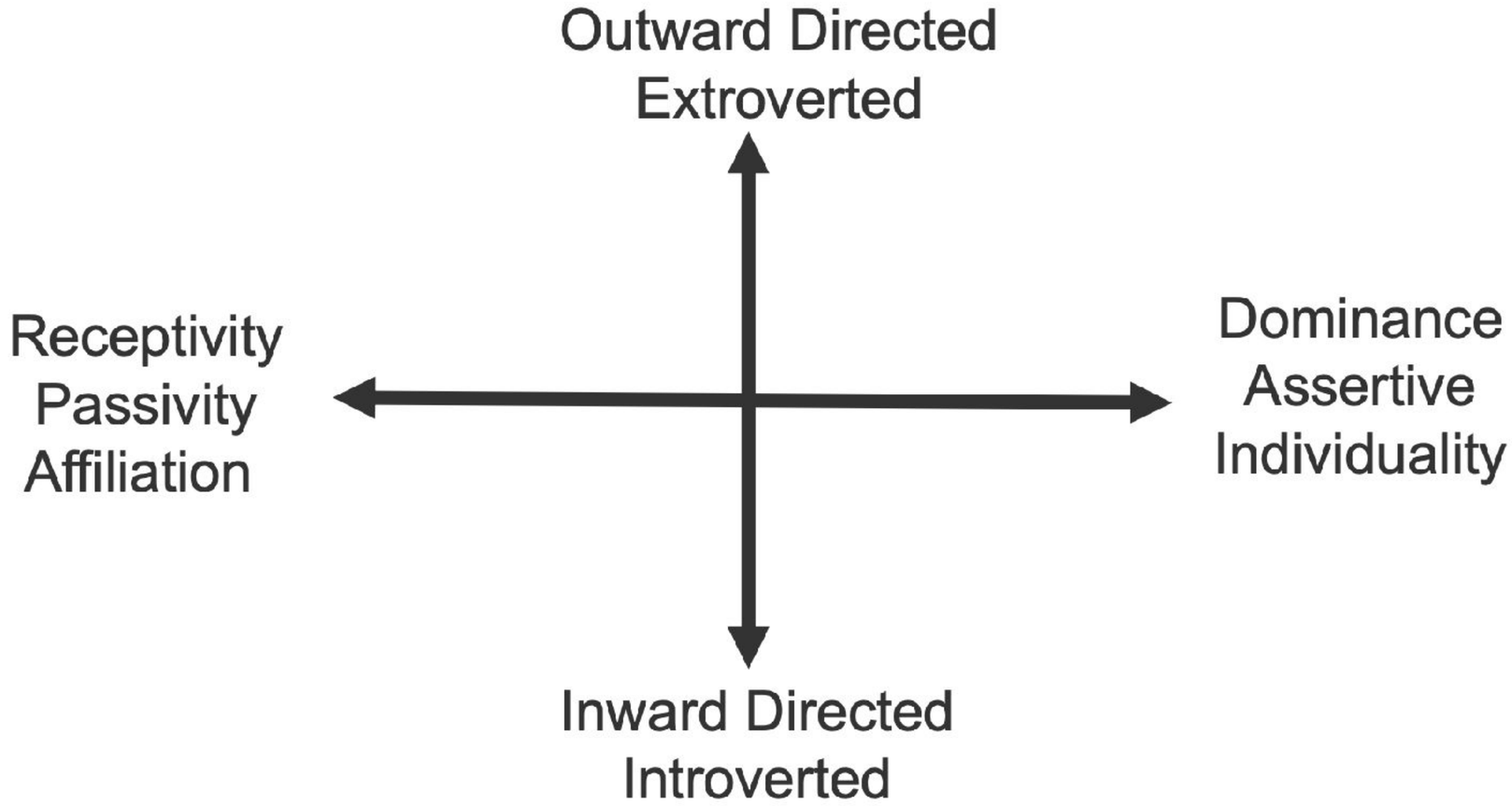
Enthusiastic Novice – No clue what he is doing, but goes out there, tries valiantly



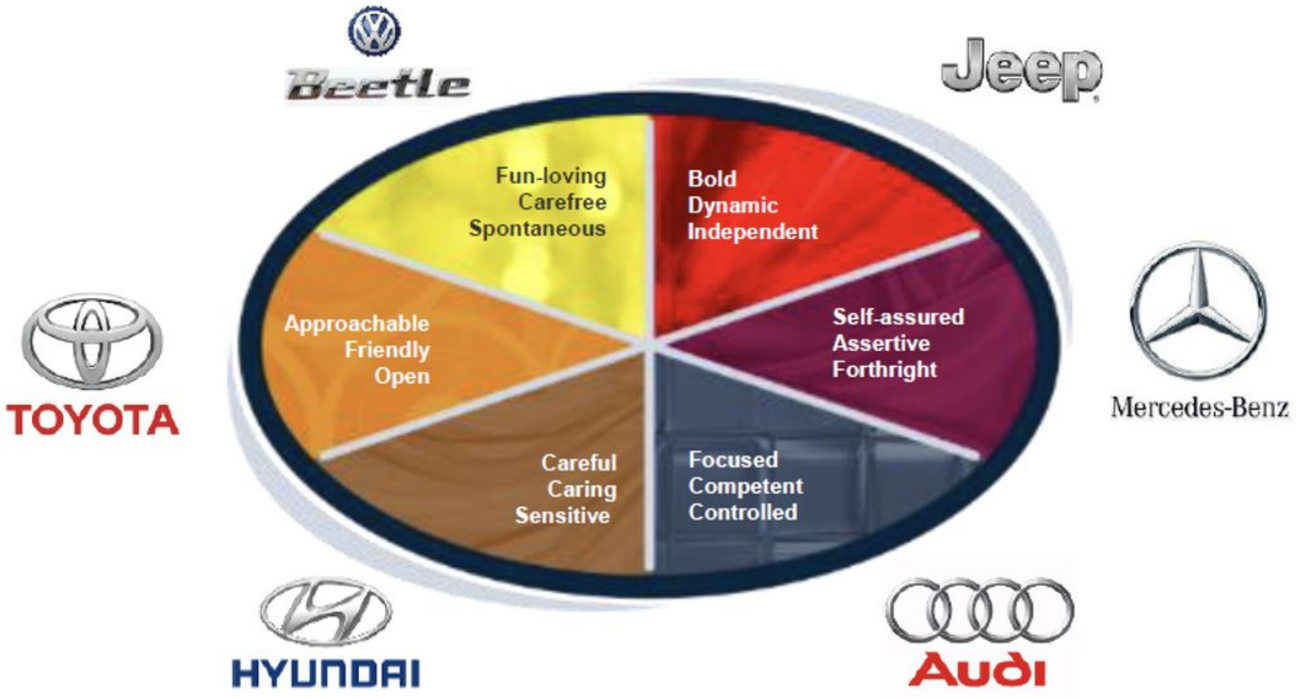
Segmenting basis psychographics - *Needscope*



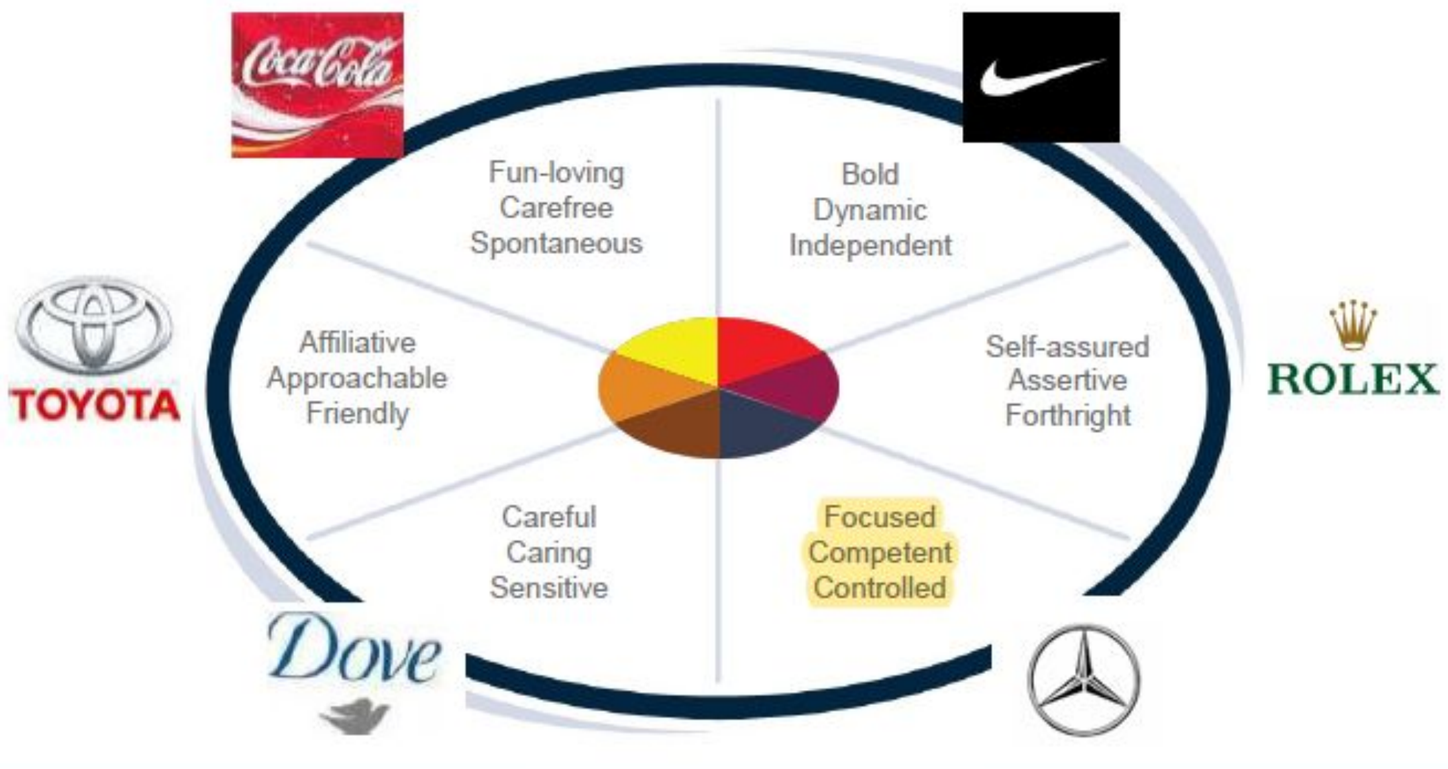
Reminder : NeedScope Axes



Segmenting basis psychographics - *Needscope*



Needscope - Examples



Group Activity

You will be given 3 personas for Sugar Cosmetics

Your task

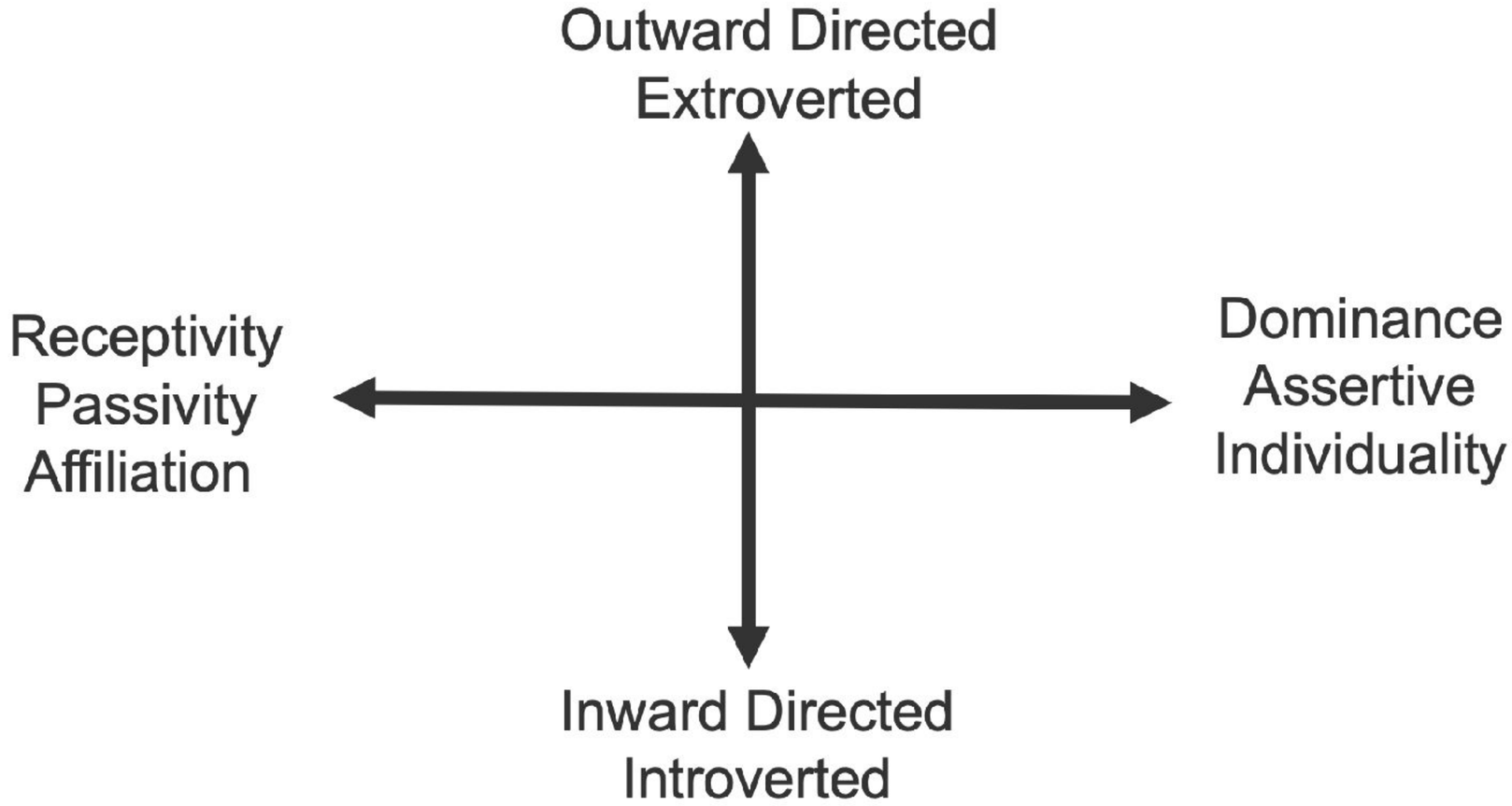
1. Plot these persona on the Needscope framework
2. Pick the recommended Target Consumer for Sugar

Time – 15 minutes

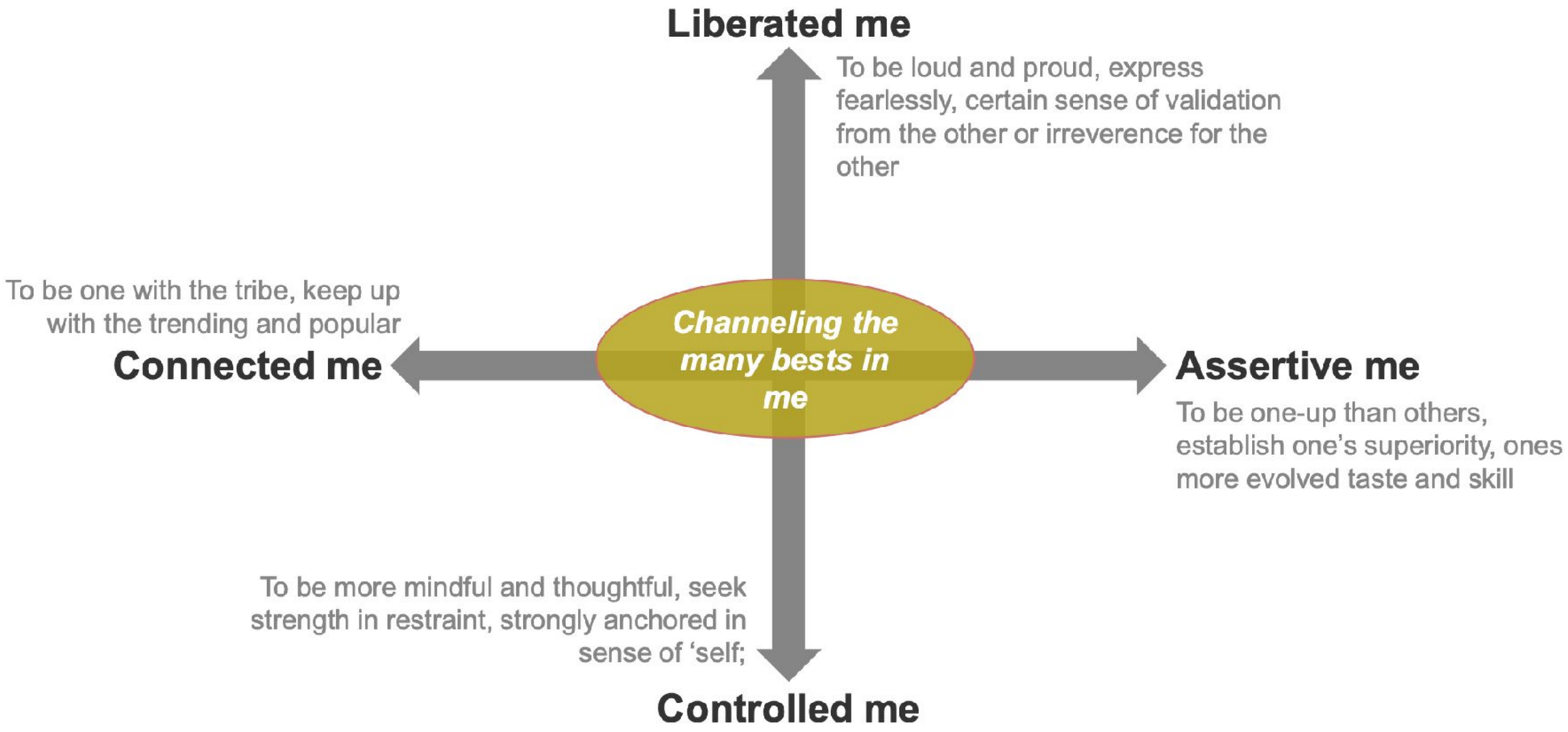
Be ready to Share



Reminder : NeedScope Axes



Needs dimensionalized



THE FREE SPIRIT

Is young at heart, carefree, playful, and likes to make the most out of the moments with friends and loved ones. She likes keeping it fresh and light and fun. Likes brands offering bright and fresh colors and pallets. Conscious of price as she seeks more variety

THE BALLSY

Bold, unconventional, out of the box, likes new challenges, open to creative and innovative products and offerings, and not afraid to try. Like brands that are bold and creative

THE OPTIMIST

Warm, friendly, social, outgoing, aspires to be a part of the popular tribe, seen as modern and not lag. Likes brands that are popular, make a noise, give the latest in the category, and show continuous momentum. Conscious of price as she seeks continuous momentum



THE DIVA

Glamorous, stylish, exclusive/ niche, premium, like the brand value, looks for most top-notch results, no compromise. Likes rich, thick/ velvety, and darker textures. Likes to play till it makes her look alluring and desirable

THE INNOCENT

Simple, sober, elegant, graceful. She is looking for elevation, not transformation/ retain self. Likes to pick brands that are tailored to Indian skin, safe to use, organic, and ensure skin health.

THE AMBITIOUS

Powerful, professional, leader, in control, likes to keep it clean and sharp, make-up part of power dressing, not too loud but visible, best in class products that are scientific and have expertise

Meet *Neha*

Demographic
Age – 26
Born – Gorakhpur,
Parents – Dad –Retail shop. Mom Housewife
Profession – First jobber, Digital marketing Agency
City of Residence - Delhi
NCCS – B

Needs, Wants, Interest & Hobbies
Friends & Family
On trend fashion style
Reading
Social media + streaming
Hangout with Friends

What do Friends & Family Say about her
Parents – Ambitious, Loving
Uncle & Aunts – Free spirited, Loving
Friends – Dreamer, Approachable, Fun loving
Colleagues – Reliable, Fun Loving



Aspirations
Want to move to creative side in the Agency
Buy a car
Road Trip of India
Stay Young
Buy a house in Delhi and move Parents
Marriage – 30 is ideal, but may end up earlier, thanks to mamma's push!

Core Values
Perpetual Seeker
Rooted
Explorer
Authentic

Attitude about Category (Color cosmetics)
Use Make Up everyday
Fun and trendy Shades – Ability to Explore
Wants Make up to keep her glow and shine and last long and look casual (Fun)
Glamour is not core to her and does not believe using make up is critical to success

Meet *Lavani*

Demographic
Age – 30
Born – Mumbai
Parents – Dad – Branch head in Bank, Mom – Teacher
Profession – Co- Founder of Stealth Start up.
Ex- Marketeer
Married, His name is Dhruv
City of Residence - Mumbai
NCCS – A

Needs, Wants, Interest & Hobbies
Friends ,Family & Partner
Basketball, Fitness
Fashion - Anything Bright!
Social media + streaming

What do Friends & Family Say about her
Parents – Bold, Go getter, Action Seeker
Uncle & Aunts – Creative, brave,
Friends – Problem Solver, Energy of the Party
Colleagues – Unhinged, Daring,



Aspirations
Wants to make her Start up a Unicorn!
Start a Basketball league for women
Set up a Mission & Podcast for Driving DEI @ education Institution.
Will have a child, when she is ready! And will be Soon
Annual getaways, with a twist!

Core Values
Individualistic
Be Bold
Freedom
Push Boundaries
Authenticity

Attitude about Category (Color cosmetics)
Use Make Up everyday
Bold & Unique Shades
Wants Make up to portray the best side of her,
helps to accentuate herself and make a statement

Meet *Aisha*

Demographic
Age – 3**5**
Born – Mumbai
Parents – Dad – Retired, Consultant. Mom –CEO of IT company
Profession – Associate Partner, Law Firm.
Married, One child 5 **years**
City of Residence - Delhi
NCCS – A

Needs, Wants, Interest & Hobbies
Friends & Family
Fitness, Yoga
Fashion, ahead of trend!
Social media + streaming

What do Friends & Family Say about her
Parents – Stubborn, Always there for us!
Uncle & Aunts – Assertive, A mind of her own
Friends – Dynamic, Forceful and Energetic
Colleagues – Get shit done. Change Agent, Tough but Fair



Aspirations
Wants to become Partner Soon
Run the 21km under 2 hours
Retire @ 45 and Work on women Rights through Public Policy
Perform on National stage through dance
Wants child to be educated under Liberal Arts

Core Values
Individualistic
Freedom + Responsibility
Imagination
Brutal Honesty
Create Impact/Transformation

Attitude about Category (Color cosmetics)
Use Make Up everyday
Bold + Muted Shades that work for her
Wants Make up to portray the best side of her helps to accentuate herself.
Quality is super Important

Neha, Free Spirit

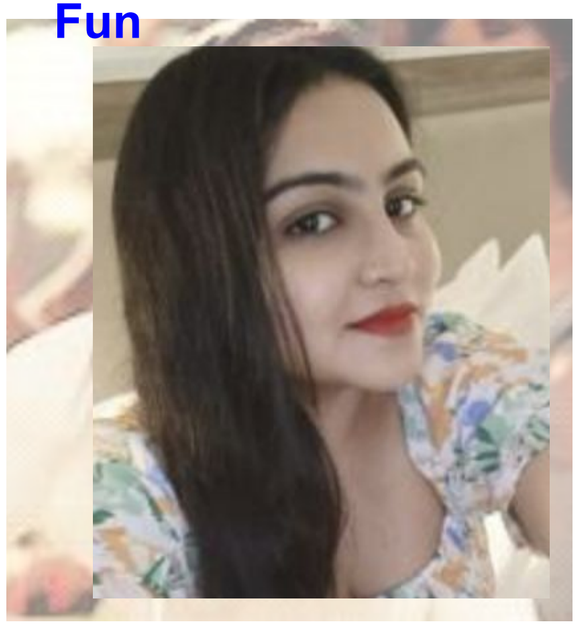
NCCS B, C

25-35

Need State - Liberation

Core value - Rooted & Restless

Payoff – Journey, Fun



Lavani, Ballsy

NCCS A

25-35

Need State – Potency - Energy

Core value –Be limitless

Payoff – Self Expression



Aisha, Ballsy

NCCS A

35-45

Need State – Potency - Assertive

Core value –Freedom + Responsibility

Payoff – Performance



Lets have a look at this ad!



Trivia – Where does the Bournvita mother sit?

THE FREE SPIRIT

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Simple, sober, elegant, graceful. She is looking for elevation, not transformation/ retain self. Likes to pick brands that are tailored to Indian skin, safe to use, organic, and ensure skin health.

THE AMBITIOUS

Powerful, professional, leader, in control, likes to keep it clean and sharp, make-up part of power dressing, not too loud but visible, best in class products that are scientific and have expertise



Targeting



Selecting Segment



Pen Portrait of Your Consumer

Bringing your consumer to life – A detailed pic of your ideal consumer

- ✔ Demographics
- ✔ Needs, Wants
- ✔ Motivation, Attitudes, Behavior
- ✔ Interest, Hobbies
- ✔ Core Values
- ✔ Symbols, Icons

Why is this important?

Insights

Gaps/Opportunities/Pain Points

Core to Marketing Mix

Stakeholder Alignment

How to create one?

Research

Detailed Note

Pen Portrait

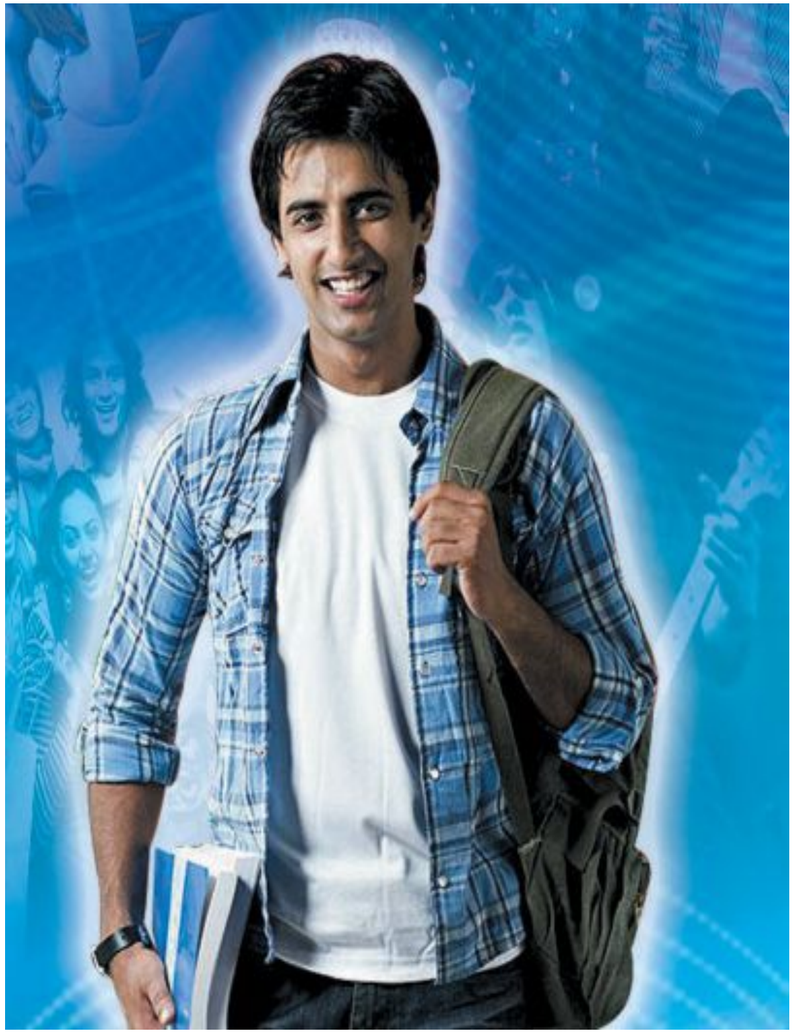
Core Values

Pen Portrait of Aditya

Demographic
Age – 21
Profession – Student, Last year college. Part time freelance over the weekend
City – Bangalore
NCCSA

Needs, Wants, Interest & Hobbies
Alternative profession – Photographer
Friends & Family
Fashion Style, very personal
Gaming & Sports
Loves Travel & Adventure

Day in the life
Hang outs
Gym
Entertainment
Gaming
Photography
Social Media



Aspirations
Alternate Profession
Car
Road Trips
Friend for Life

Attitude about Category (Deo)
Funny ads, but why is all about sex
Deos is not about confidence, have all of it
Just need it to last and odour is not an impediment

Core Values
Individualistic
Perpetual Seeker
Rooted
Social Recognition
Sense of Purpose

Core Values - A core value is a deeply held belief about what matters most in life. It guides how a person thinks, behaves, and makes choices—even in small things like what brand to buy.

Individualistic

- Delayed adult milestones
- “so much more to do in my life”
- Staying away from home
- Disinterested in long standing institutions – E.g – Religion
- Career oriented
- Writing his own rules

Perpetual Seeker

- Have it all….want it all
- Fear of missing out
- Always assessing on what is missing
- Desire to Upgrade
- Trend setter

Rooted to Family

- Always plugged in with family
- Seeks support and advice from parents

Social Recognition

- Peer affirmations
- Multiple gangs
- Mentorship that is always on with friends

Sense of Purpose

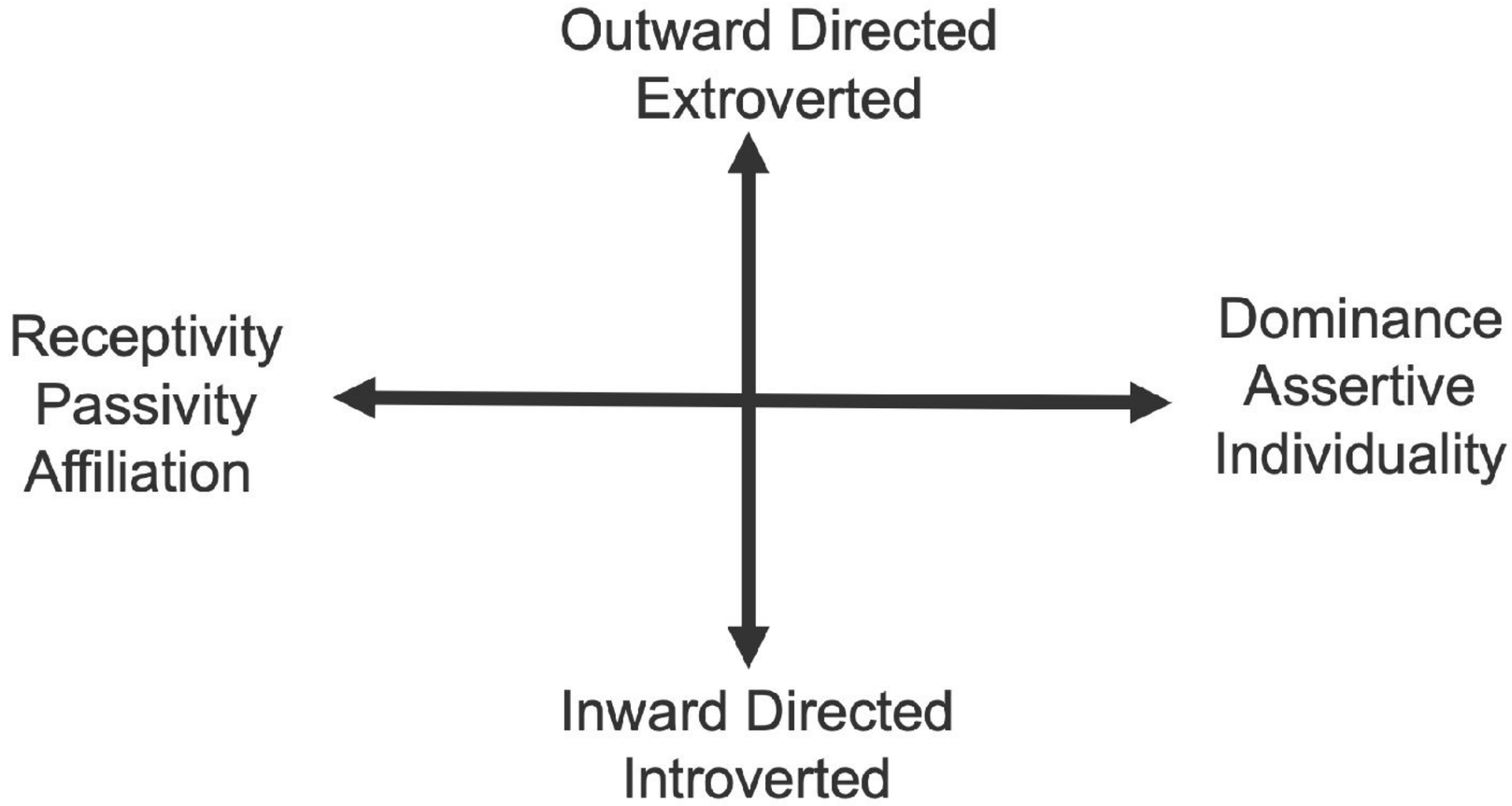
- Demands ethics from his relationships be it friends or work
- Wants to help out ….contribute back to the society

Exercise - 7



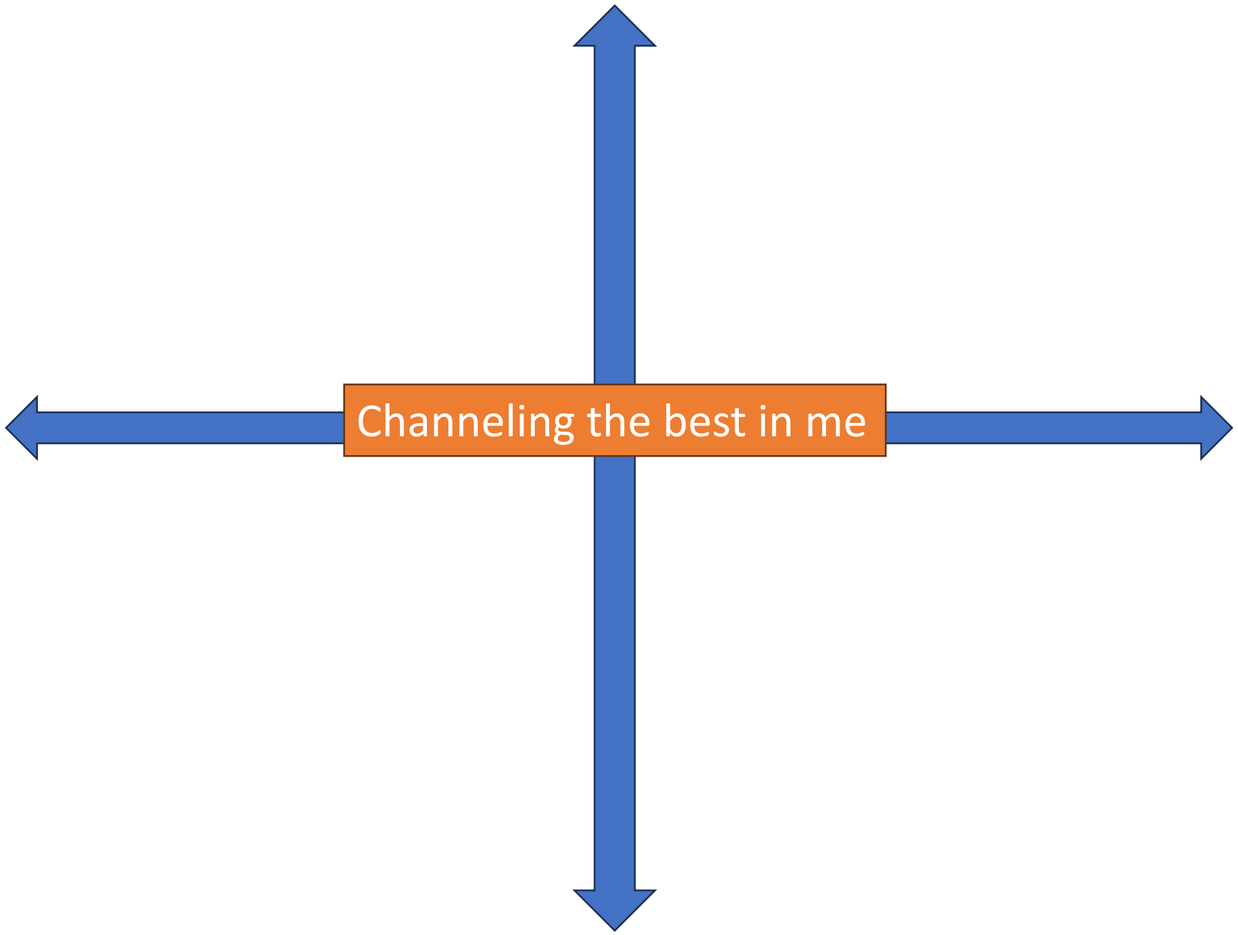
Make a Pen Portrait of Mother for a new MOMS Appliance Company – Core product Breast pumps

Reminder : NeedScope Axes



Shape the world around me

Connection & Shared Experiences



Autonomy & Self Direction

Safeguard what matters most


Shape the world around me
Exploration
Mastery
Connection & Shared Experiences
Belonging
Channeling the best in me
Recognition
Autonomy & Self Direction
Comfort
Security
Safeguard what matters most

Exploration- The need to experience freedom, novelty and possibility. People in this state are driven by curiosity and a desire to break away from routine. They seek new ideas, places, experiences and perspectives that broaden their horizons and make life feel richer. They value brands that inspire discovery, encourage experimentation and help them embrace the unknown.

Mastery- need to shape one's own life through capability, confidence and agency. People in this state are motivated by the desire to grow, improve and take charge of outcomes rather than be constrained by circumstances. They derive satisfaction from developing skills, overcoming challenges and unlocking their potential. They seek products, services and experiences that empower them to perform better, make smarter decisions and live life on their own terms.

Belonging- The need to build meaningful relationships and feel connected to others. People in this state value companionship, shared experiences and a sense of community. They seek acceptance, emotional closeness and mutual support, gravitating towards brands that strengthen relationships and foster togetherness.

Recognition- The need to express individuality and be seen for who one is. People in this state seek self-expression, appreciation and social affirmation. They use products and experiences to communicate identity, celebrate achievements and create memorable moments. They are drawn to brands that help them stand out, feel special and reinforce their sense of self.

Comfort- The need for emotional and physical ease, reassurance and wellbeing. People in this state seek calm, warmth and relief from stress or uncertainty. They value familiarity, care and environments that help them feel safe, restored and at peace. Brands that reduce friction, provide reassurance and create moments of comfort naturally resonate here.

Security- The need for stability, certainty and control over one's life. People in this state are motivated by reducing risk, protecting what they value and preparing for the future. They seek predictability, reliability and confidence in their decisions, preferring brands that inspire trust, minimise uncertainty and help them feel in control.

Exercise - 7



Plot Specific Brand Consumers of Mom Care Products in following needscope

Orimi, Moms Co, Medela, Earth Mama & Pro MOM

HINT – watch ads, read websites and see packaging to identify key motivations of a mother they are focusing on

Which psychographic is the potential whitespace and then make a pen portrait for that consumer

Psychographics

Need State	Core Psychographics
Mastery	**Ambitious, self-reliant, capable, determined, growth-oriented, achievement-driven, in-control**
Recognition	**Expressive, confident, individualistic, status-aware, validation-seeking, identity-conscious, proud**
Exploration	**Curious, adventurous, open-minded, spontaneous, novelty-seeking, experimental, freedom-seeking**
Belonging	**Sociable, inclusive, relationship-oriented, collaborative, community-minded, affectionate, affiliative**
Comfort	**Reassurance-seeking, nurturing, sensitive, ease-seeking, familiar, restorative, emotionally grounded**
Security	**Cautious, responsible, risk-aware, structured, dependable, certainty-seeking, prepared**